Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/31

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 31: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

From a secret report written by a local public health official in Saxony, December 1935.

"The implementation of the Law for the Prevention of Hereditarily Diseased Offspring is proceeding smoothly, though we must confront lingering traditional prejudices. In this district, we have processed over eighty applications for compulsory sterilisation this year alone. While some families initially protest out of ignorance, the majority are brought to understand that eliminating hereditary defects is a biological duty to the state. The local courts have been highly cooperative, accepting medical recommendations without delay. However, we require more secure facilities to prevent patients from fleeing before the surgical procedures are completed."

Source C

An official Nazi propaganda poster, published by the Office of Racial Policy in 1938. The German text translates to: "60,000 Reichsmarks is what this person suffering from a hereditary defect costs the People's community during his lifetime. Fellow citizen, that is your money too."



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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

From The Nazi State and Society by Dr. Julian Kroll, published in 1998.

"The persecution of minorities and disabled people under the Nazi regime was fundamentally driven by a deeply ingrained biological and racial ideology. From the moment they seized power, the Nazis utilized the legal system and public health networks to implement eugenics policies. The German medical profession was highly complicit, willingly submitting thousands of patients for compulsory sterilisation. The general public largely conformed to these measures because they had been thoroughly indoctrinated by racial hygiene propaganda in schools and media. This pseudoscience convinced ordinary citizens that sterilising the disabled was essential to protect the purity of the Aryan gene pool."

Interpretation 2

From The Economics of Terror by Professor Arthur Kitson, published in 2004.

"While racial rhetoric was always present, the driving force behind the escalating persecution of disabled people was economic utility. During the Great Depression, the Nazi state sought to justify its welfare cuts by portraying the vulnerable as a parasitic financial burden on the hard-working taxpayer. Propaganda deliberately targeted the cost of care to build resentment among workers who were themselves enduring long hours and low wages. Active resistance to these policies was minimal because the police state successfully silenced dissent. However, when the regime transitioned from sterilisation to the secret T4 euthanasia programme, public alarm grew, showing that conformity relied on keeping the ultimate fate of these victims hidden from their families."

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